General Dessert #7: Volunteer Monitors and HF Operating

Volunteer Monitor Program, station logs, contesting basics, CQ procedure, long-path and azimuthal maps, NATO phonetics, QRP, and signal reports.

Group G2D · 11 pool questions · Self-study reference · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

Key Facts Reference

Volunteer Monitor Program

Question	Answer	Q
What is the Volunteer Monitor Program?	**Amateur volunteers formally enlisted to monitor the airwaves for rules violations.**	G2D01
Objective of the program	**To encourage amateurs to self-regulate and comply with the rules.** It is education-and-compliance, not enforcement.	G2D02
Localizing a stuck carrier on a repeater	**Compare beam headings on the repeater input from multiple Volunteer Monitor locations** – triangulation.	G2D03

HF Calling and Operating Procedure

Topic	Answer	Q
How to call CQ on HF	**Repeat "CQ" a few times, then "this is" and your call sign a few times, pause to listen, repeat as needed.**	G2D05
Long-path antenna heading	**180 degrees from the short-path heading** – the opposite great-circle direction.	G2D06
Azimuthal projection map	**Shows true bearings and distances from a specific (center) location.** Essential for HF DXing and pointing beams.	G2D04
NATO Phonetic Alphabet example	**Alpha, Bravo, Charlie, Delta.** Not Able/Baker (older), not Adam/Boy (LE/APCO).	G2D07
What is QRP operation?	**Low-power transmit operation** (typically 5 W CW / 10 W SSB or less).	G2D10
Why exchange signal reports at start of QSO	**To allow each station to operate according to conditions** – adjust power, mode, antenna based on what the other end hears.	G2D11

Logs and Contests

Topic	Answer	Q
Why keep a station log	**To help with a reply if the FCC requests information about your station.** Logs are not required by FCC for routine operating.	G2D08
Requirement when contesting on HF	**Identify your station according to normal FCC regulations.** Log submission and QSLing are sponsor or operator choices, not legal requirements.	G2D09

Dessert 7 Question Bank (G2D)

G2D01. What is the Volunteer Monitor Program?
A. Amateur volunteers who are formally enlisted to monitor the airwaves for rules violations
B. Amateur volunteers who conduct amateur licensing examinations
C. Amateur volunteers who conduct frequency coordination for amateur VHF repeaters
D. Amateur volunteers who use their station equipment to help civil defense organizations in times of emergency

G2D02. Which of the following are objectives of the Volunteer Monitor Program?
A. To conduct efficient and orderly amateur licensing examinations
B. To provide emergency and public safety communications
C. To coordinate repeaters for efficient and orderly spectrum usage
D. To encourage amateur radio operators to self-regulate and comply with the rules

G2D03. What procedure may be used by Volunteer Monitors to localize a station whose continuous carrier is holding a repeater on in their area?
A. Compare vertical and horizontal signal strengths on the input frequency
B. Compare beam headings on the repeater input from their home locations with that of other Volunteer Monitors
C. Compare signal strengths between the input and output of the repeater
D. All these choices are correct

G2D04. Which of the following describes an azimuthal projection map?
A. A map that shows accurate land masses
B. A map that shows true bearings and distances from a specific location
C. A map that shows the angle at which an amateur satellite crosses the equator
D. A map that shows the number of degrees longitude that an amateur satellite appears to move westward at the equator with each orbit

G2D05. Which of the following indicates that you are looking for an HF contact with any station?
A. Sign your call sign once, followed by the words “listening for a call” – if no answer, change frequency and repeat
B. Say “QTC” followed by “this is” and your call sign – if no answer, change frequency and repeat
C. Repeat “CQ” a few times, followed by “this is,” then your call sign a few times, then pause to listen, repeat as necessary
D. Transmit an unmodulated carried for approximately 10 seconds, followed by “this is” and your call sign, and pause to listen – repeat as necessary

G2D06. How is a directional antenna pointed when making a “long-path” contact with another station?
A. Toward the rising sun
B. Along the gray line
C. 180 degrees from the station’s short-path heading
D. Toward the north

G2D07. Which of the following are examples of the NATO Phonetic Alphabet?
A. Able, Baker, Charlie, Dog
B. Adam, Boy, Charles, David
C. America, Boston, Canada, Denmark
D. Alpha, Bravo, Charlie, Delta

G2D08. Why do many amateurs keep a station log?
A. The FCC requires a log of all international contacts
B. The FCC requires a log of all international third-party traffic
C. The log provides evidence of operation needed to renew a license without retest
D. To help with a reply if the FCC requests information about your station

G2D09. Which of the following is required when participating in a contest on HF frequencies?
A. Submit a log to the contest sponsor
B. Send a QSL card to the stations worked, or QSL via Logbook of The World
C. Identify your station according to normal FCC regulations
D. All these choices are correct

G2D10. What is QRP operation?
A. Remote piloted model control
B. Low-power transmit operation
C. Transmission using Quick Response Protocol
D. Traffic relay procedure net operation

G2D11. Why are signal reports typically exchanged at the beginning of an HF contact?
A. To allow each station to operate according to conditions
B. To be sure the contact will count for award programs
C. To follow standard radiogram structure
D. To allow each station to calibrate their frequency display

Answer Key

G2D01: A	G2D02: D	G2D03: B	G2D04: B
G2D05: C	G2D06: C	G2D07: D	G2D08: D
G2D09: C	G2D10: B	G2D11: A	